

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF CIVIL AVIATION
RAJYA SABHA
UNSTARRED QUESTION NO : 1089
(TO BE ANSWERED ON THE 13th February 2019)

DIFFICULTIES IN RCS

1089. SHRI V. VIJAYASAI REDDY

Will the Minister of CIVIL AVIATION be pleased to state:-

- (a) the status of Government's goal of bringing 100 million more passengers to the skies by 2022;
- (b) how Government is going to achieve the above target through its Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS) when only 16 out of 31 new airports have become operational by 2017;
- (c) whether States are finding it difficult to provide basic infrastructure and other amenities at proposed new airports;
- (d) whether Government is determined to open the remaining 15 airports by June, 2019;
- (e) if so, the status of the same; and
- (f) reasons why just 60 out of 128 planned routes are only in operation so far?

ANSWER

MINISTER OF STATE IN THE MINISTRY OF CIVIL AVIATION

(Shri Jayant Sinha)

- (a): National Civil Aviation Policy, 2016 targets to create an ecosystem to make flying affordable for the masses and to enable 30 crore domestic ticketing by 2022. As per the Airports Authority of India's forecast, all Indian airports taken together are expected to handle 640 million passengers by the year 2024-25.
 - (b): Under UDAN 1 & 2, 56 unserved airports are to be operationalised. Out of these 56 airports, 23 airports have been operationalised. Under UDAN 3, routes connecting 13 unique unserved airports have been awarded on 25.01.2019.
 - (c) : Except Goa, Mizoram, Chandigarh, Delhi, Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Lakshadweep, 30 States and Union Territories have signed the tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Ministry of Civil Aviation and Airports Authority of India for providing concession as envisaged in the RCS Scheme document to the Selected Airline Operator at RCS airports located in their respective State.
- Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs has approved the proposal for revival of 50 existing un-served/underserved airports/airstrips of the State Governments,

Airports Authority of India and Civil Enclaves at an estimated cost of Rs. 4500 crores, in three financial years starting from 2017-18.

Further, the revival of airports under Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS)-UDAN (Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik) is 'demand driven', depending upon firm commitment from airline operators as well as from the State Government for providing various concessions.

(d)&(e): Revival of airports need appropriate infrastructure and compliance of licencing requirement. Remaining airports are likely to become operational within six months.

(f): So far, 72 routes out of 128 under UDAN 1 and 66 routes of UDAN 2 have been operationalised. The remaining routes are likely to be operationalised within six months after completion of airport infrastructure works/ airlines operational issues.
